

THE FRIEDMAN TEAM

THE CARROLL COUNTY TOWN BY TOWN BUYER'S GUIDE

*Which Carroll County town fits your budget,
your commute, and your life?*

OCTOBER 2026 EDITION





CARROLL COUNTY AT A GLANCE

Chapter 2 of 12

THE BIG PICTURE

Carroll County sits between Baltimore and Frederick, and its towns each feel and price differently. Use this guide to narrow to two or three towns before you tour a single home.

One County, Many Markets.

Bright MLS closed sales, March 25 to September 21, 2026.

1,227

HOMES SOLD IN 11 TOWNS
in about six months

6 to 24 days

MEDIAN DAYS TO CONTRACT
depending on the town

8 of 11

TOWNS AT FULL PRICE
median sale at or above
original list

Inside.

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Source: Bright MLS, residential closed sales by city, March 25 to September 21, 2026. Medians. Figures for small towns can swing.





WHAT YOU CAN AFFORD

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YOUR MONTHLY COST

Your price range comes from your monthly payment. Here is what each price costs each month at today's rate, then the other costs to plan for.

Price to Payment.

30 year fixed at 6.95 percent, 10 percent down.

PURCHASE PRICE	LOAN AMOUNT (10% DOWN)	MONTHLY PRINCIPAL AND INTEREST
\$350,000	\$315,000	\$2,085
\$400,000	\$360,000	\$2,383
\$450,000	\$405,000	\$2,681
\$500,000	\$450,000	\$2,979
\$550,000	\$495,000	\$3,277
\$600,000	\$540,000	\$3,575

Property tax.

County plus state is \$1.130 per \$100 of assessed value in unincorporated areas like Eldersburg and Finksburg. Each town adds its own rate, shown on its page. On a \$450,000 assessed value that is about \$5,085 a year, up to \$7,605 in Westminster.

Insurance and closing.

Plan on about 2 to 3 percent of the purchase price for buyer closing costs, plus homeowners insurance. We price both for the exact home.

A quarter point matters.

A quarter of a percent change in your rate moves the payment on a \$450,000 purchase by about \$68 a month. We will run your exact numbers with a lender.

Rate is the Freddie Mac 30 year fixed average released September 17, 2026. Principal and interest only; taxes, insurance, and any mortgage insurance are additional.





WESTMINSTER

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TOWN PROFILE

Westminster is the county seat of Carroll County. It has the county's downtown and its main government and business center, and it is one of the larger markets, with 339 closed sales in about six months. Its town tax is \$0.56 per \$100, for a total real property rate of \$1.690 per \$100.

Westminster at a Glance.

Closed sales, March 25 to September 21, 2026.

\$460,000

MEDIAN SOLD PRICE

339 homes sold

10 days

MEDIAN DAYS TO CONTRACT

100.0%

SOLD VS. ORIGINAL LIST

112 homes for sale now

Kyle's Take.

Westminster is the biggest market in the county: 339 sales in about six months and 112 homes for sale right now, more choice than anywhere else in Carroll. Homes still go under contract in 10 days, so I get you pre approved before we tour. The tradeoff is the highest tax rate in the guide, so I run your full monthly cost first.

Before you buy in Westminster, ask:

1. Which school attendance zone is this exact address in? Check the county locator.
2. What is the total tax rate at this address?
3. What is the commute to your workplace at 8 a.m.?





SOUTH CARROLL

Chapter 5 of 12

THREE TOWNS, ONE SIDE OF THE COUNTY

Eldersburg, Sykesville, and Finksburg make up the southern side of the county, closest to the Baltimore County line. Sykesville and Eldersburg homes sell in about a week at the median.

South Carroll at a Glance.

Closed sales, March 25 to September 21, 2026.

Eldersburg

Median sold price \$632,500, 6 days to contract, sold at 100.9% of original list.

82 homes sold, 24 for sale now.

Unincorporated, so no town tax. The total rate is \$1.130 per \$100. The highest median price of the larger towns here, and one of the fastest paces.

Sykesville

Median sold price \$550,000, 6 days to contract, sold at 100.0% of original list.

206 homes sold, 32 for sale now.

A small historic downtown with newer neighborhoods around it. Town tax \$0.32, total \$1.450 per \$100.

Finksburg

Median sold price \$539,000, 14 days to contract, sold at 99.1% of original list.

59 homes sold, 19 for sale now.

Unincorporated, in the southeast near the Baltimore County line. Total rate \$1.130 per \$100.

Kyle's Take.

This is where you compete. Eldersburg and Sykesville homes go under contract in about 6 days at the median, and Sykesville has less than one month of supply. I get buyers ready before we ever tour, because there is no second week. Finksburg gives you a little more time at 14 days.





HAMPSTEAD AND MANCHESTER

Chapter 6 of 12

NORTHERN CARROLL

Hampstead and Manchester sit in the northern part of the county. Hampstead has one of the lower median prices among the larger towns.

Two Northern Towns.

Closed sales, March 25 to September 21, 2026.

Hampstead

Median sold price \$402,500, 8 days to contract, sold at 100.0% of original list.

134 homes sold, 33 for sale now.

One of the more affordable of the larger towns. Town tax \$0.22, total \$1.350 per \$100.

Manchester

Median sold price \$460,000, 18 days to contract, sold at 100.0% of original list.

71 homes sold, 28 for sale now.

Town tax \$0.216, total \$1.346 per \$100. Homes take a little longer here than in Hampstead.

Kyle's Take.

Hampstead is the value play in northern Carroll: a \$402,500 median, 8 days to contract, and a \$1.350 tax rate. Manchester runs about \$460,000 and gives you a little more time at 18 days. Both sell at full price, so we go in with a clean, strong offer.

Before you buy in either town, ask:

1. Which school attendance zone is this exact address in? Check the county locator.
2. What is the total tax rate at this address?
3. What is the commute to your workplace at 8 a.m.?





MOUNT AIRY

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TOWN PROFILE

Mount Airy sits on the Carroll and Frederick County line along Interstate 70 and has the highest median sold price in this guide. On the Carroll side the town tax is \$0.1962, for a total of \$1.3262 per \$100. Confirm the county for the exact address, since the town crosses the county line.

Mount Airy at a Glance.

Closed sales, March 25 to September 21, 2026.

\$675,000

MEDIAN SOLD PRICE

171 homes sold

9 days

MEDIAN DAYS TO CONTRACT

100.0%

SOLD VS. ORIGINAL LIST

48 homes for sale now

Kyle's Take.

Mount Airy has the highest median price in this guide at \$675,000, and homes still go under contract in 9 days. The Carroll side tax rate of \$1.3262 is the lowest of the incorporated towns, which helps offset the price. Check which county the address sits in before you fall in love with a house.

Before you buy in Mount Airy, ask:

1. Which school attendance zone is this exact address in? Check the county locator.
2. What is the total tax rate at this address?
3. What is the commute to your workplace at 8 a.m.?





NEW WINDSOR AND TANEYTOWN

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WEST AND NORTH

New Windsor and Taneytown are smaller towns. Taneytown has one of the lowest median prices in the guide, and homes in New Windsor take the longest to go under contract.

Two Smaller Towns.

Closed sales, March 25 to September 21, 2026.

New Windsor

Median sold price \$500,000, 24 days to contract, sold at 100.0% of original list.

53 homes sold, 14 for sale now.

Western Carroll County. Town tax \$0.2615, total \$1.3915 per \$100. The slowest pace in the guide at the median, so buyers may have more time.

Taneytown

Median sold price \$380,000, 11 days to contract, sold at 99.8% of original list.

73 homes sold, 26 for sale now.

Northern Carroll County, with the lowest median price in the guide. Town tax \$0.37, total \$1.500 per \$100.

Kyle's Take.

Taneytown is your entry point: a \$380,000 median, the lowest in this guide, and homes sell in 11 days. New Windsor moves slower at 24 days, which gives you more time to decide. For both, I confirm the exact tax rate and the real commute before you write an offer.

Before you buy in either town, ask:

1. Which school attendance zone is this exact address in? Check the county locator.
2. What is the total tax rate at this address?
3. What is the commute to your workplace at 8 a.m.?





UNION BRIDGE AND UPPERCO

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SMALL MARKETS

Union Bridge and Upperco are the smallest markets in this guide, and a handful of sales can swing the numbers. Treat these figures as a direction and ask us for the current homes and recent sales.

Small Towns, Small Samples.

Closed sales, March 25 to September 21, 2026.

Union Bridge

Median sold price \$387,500, 7 days to contract, sold at 100.0% of original list.

24 homes sold, 11 for sale now.

Western Carroll County, a small town.

Town tax \$0.35, total \$1.480 per \$100.

A small sample of sales, so the median can move a lot.

Upperco

Median sold price \$500,000, 20 days to contract, sold at 97.5% of original list.

15 homes sold, 7 for sale now.

Zip code 21155, in the northern Baltimore County and Carroll County area.

Carroll side total rate \$1.130 per \$100, Baltimore County side \$1.212.

Only 15 homes sold, so this is directional only.

Kyle's Take

These markets are small, so I do not treat a median as gospel. I pull the actual recent sales that match your budget and show you what they really sold for. Ask me for the list.





ALL TOWNS COMPARED

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SIDE BY SIDE

Use this page to shortlist. A lower price and a slower pace usually means more room to negotiate. A higher price and a faster pace means preparing to move quickly.

Compare at a Glance.

Closed sales, March 25 to September 21, 2026.

TOWN	MEDIAN SOLD PRICE	MEDIAN DAYS TO CONTRACT	SOLD VS. ORIGINAL LIST	HOMES SOLD	MONTHS OF SUPPLY
Westminster	\$460,000	10	100.0%	339	1.9
Eldersburg	\$632,500	6	100.9%	82	1.7
Sykesville	\$550,000	6	100.0%	206	0.9
Finksburg	\$539,000	14	99.1%	59	1.9
Hampstead	\$402,500	8	100.0%	134	1.5
Manchester	\$460,000	18	100.0%	71	2.3
Mount Airy	\$675,000	9	100.0%	171	1.7
New Windsor	\$500,000	24	100.0%	53	1.6
Taneytown	\$380,000	11	99.8%	73	2.1
Union Bridge	\$387,500	7	100.0%	24	2.7
Upperco	\$500,000	20	97.5%	15	2.8

Source: Bright MLS, residential closed sales by city, March 25 to September 21, 2026. Months of supply is homes for sale now divided by monthly sales; under 4 months favors sellers. Mount Airy and Upperco cross county lines. Small towns swing.





HOW TO WIN AN OFFER RIGHT NOW

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YOUR EDGE

In most Carroll County towns, the typical home goes under contract in under three weeks and sells at or above its original list price. That rewards a buyer who is ready to move.

Offer Like You Mean It.

Four moves that matter this fall.

Get fully pre approved.

A verified pre approval, not a pre qualification, lets you move the day the right home appears.

Know your town's pace.

In Sykesville and Eldersburg the median home went under contract in about 6 days. In New Windsor it took 24. Use the days on page 10.

Expect to pay full price in most towns.

In 8 of 11 towns the median home sold at or above its original list price. Lead with a strong, clean offer.

Lock your rate early.

Rates rose four weeks in a row into September 2026. Once you have a contract, talk to your lender about locking.





YOUR NEXT STEP

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LET'S TALK

You now know which towns fit your budget. The next step is to see real homes and run your exact numbers.

Which Town Fits You?

Let's run your numbers.



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SEARCH CARROLL COUNTY HOMES



WHAT IS MY HOME WORTH?

Numbers over guesswork.

